Streaming catalogue: where the audience goes, and where the value is

Acquisition explorer · 2,500 films, 1970-2023, 167 million audience votes



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Report author · Binge Metrics Streaming Group

Source: Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx (as loaded in the model) · IMDb-style ratings and votes

Start the story

The brief: help the acquisitions team find value in the catalogue

Aim
Show the acquisitions team where audience attention goes, what predicts a well-rated film, and which films and directors are worth licensing.

Questions this report answers

- How is the catalogue spread across decades, genres and runtimes?
- How concentrated is audience attention?
- Does popularity or genre predict a good rating?
- Where are the well-rated films that few people have seen?
- Which directors have the strongest track records?

2,500
films

167.4M
audience votes

6.55
average rating

284
directors with 5+ films

20 genres (about two per film), 2,000 people, 1970-2023.
Titles and people are anonymised, and the source workbook is missing; numbers come from the data stored in the model.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 2

Attention is concentrated, popularity says nothing about quality, and 415 gems wait

2,500	167.4M	6.55	415
films	audience votes	average rating	hidden gems

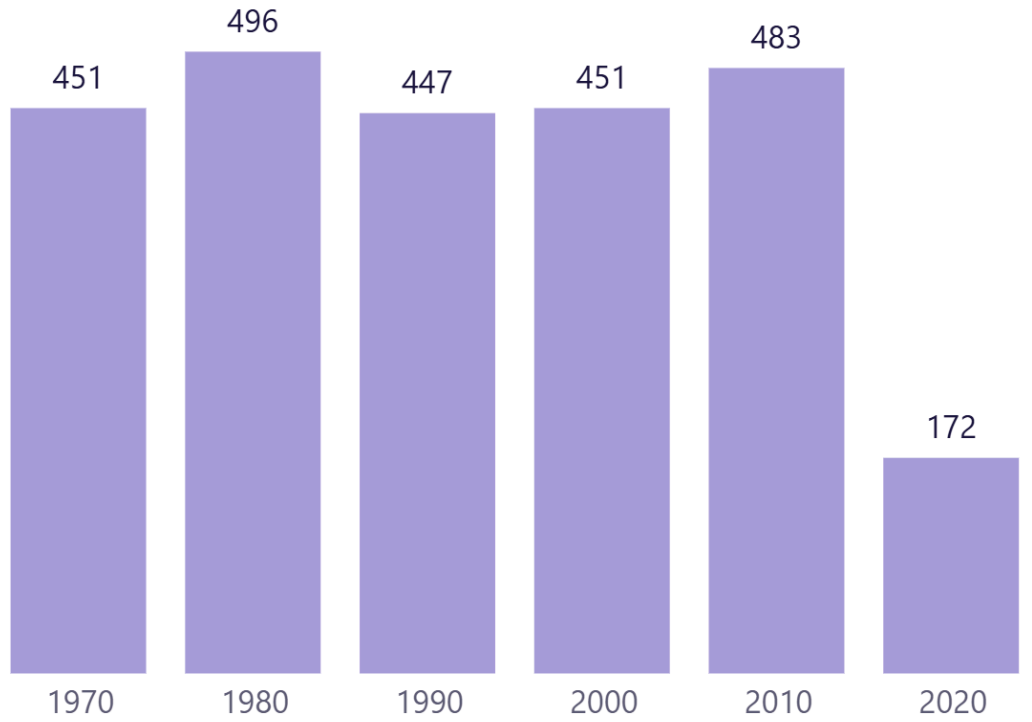
CONCENTRATED	**Audience attention**	7% of films hold 65% of all votes; the bottom half hold 2.6%
NO LINK	**Popularity and quality**	Low-vote films average 6.53, high-vote films 6.59
OPPORTUNITY	**Hidden gems**	415 films rated 7.5+ with under 25,000 votes get just 1.4% of votes
WEAK SIGNAL	**Genre**	All 20 genres average between 6.4 and 6.8
STRONG SIGNAL	**Directors**	Director averages range from 5.1 to 7.7; 41 average 7 or more

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 3

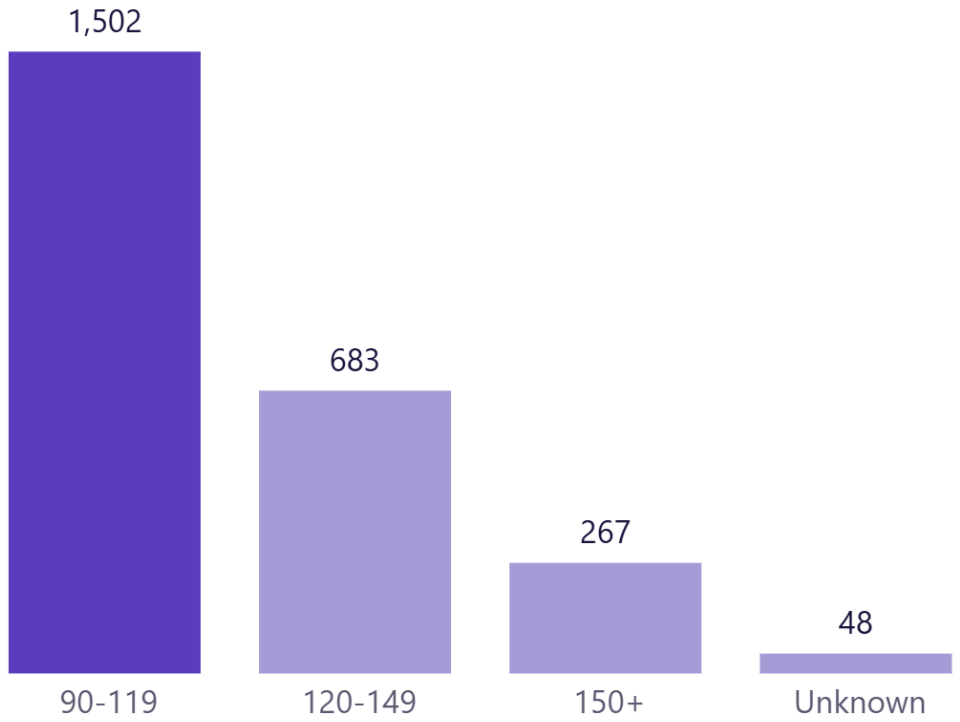
Dashboards

Six in ten films run 90-119 minutes; each decade holds 450-500 films

Films by decade



Films by runtime



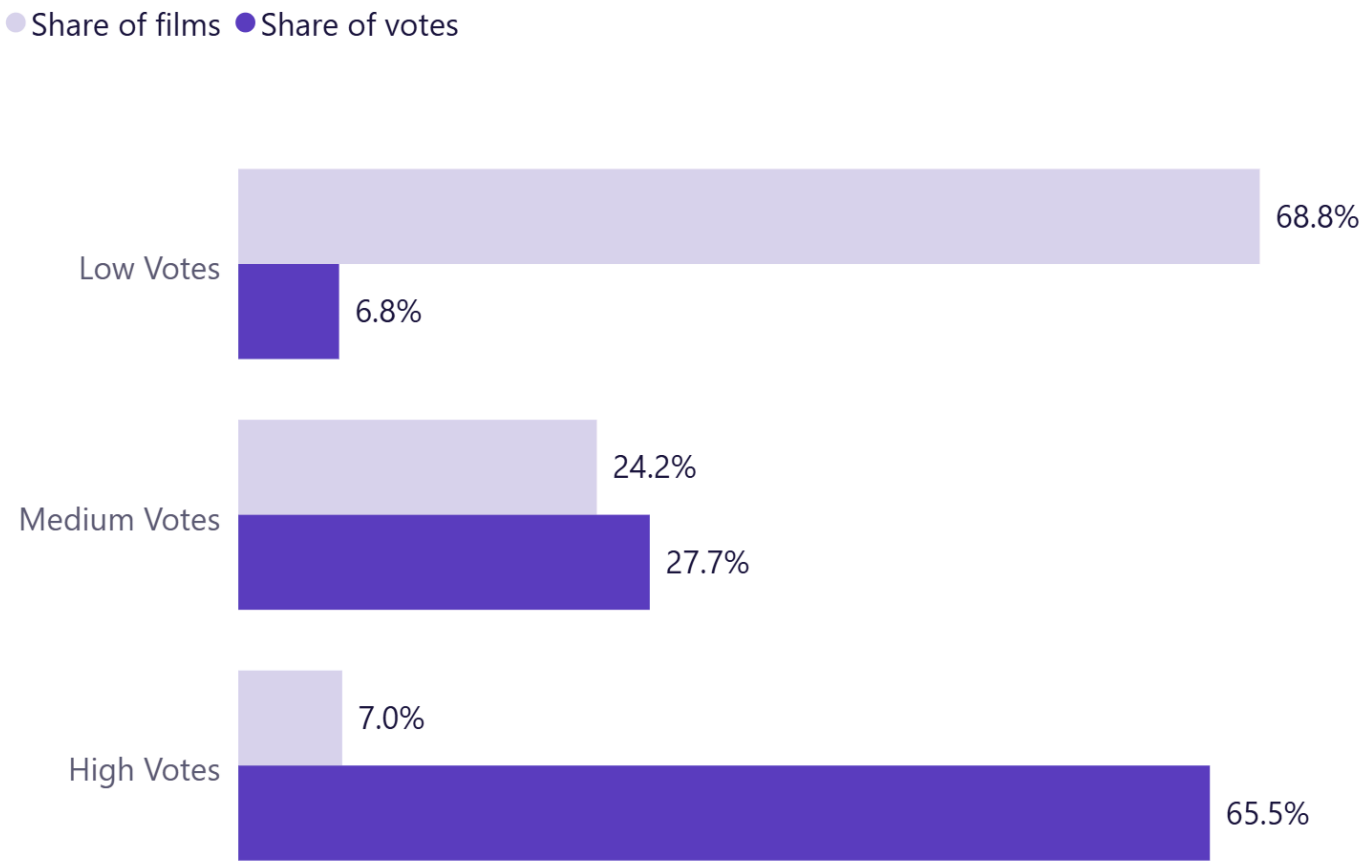
The 2020s cover only 2020-2023, and 48 films have no runtime (shown as Unknown; they were labelled "Under 60" before).

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 4

Dashboards

7% of films hold 65% of all votes; the top 10% hold 74%

Share of films and share of votes, by vote level



74.3%
of votes go to the 10% most-voted films

8,720
votes for the typical film (max 1.97M)

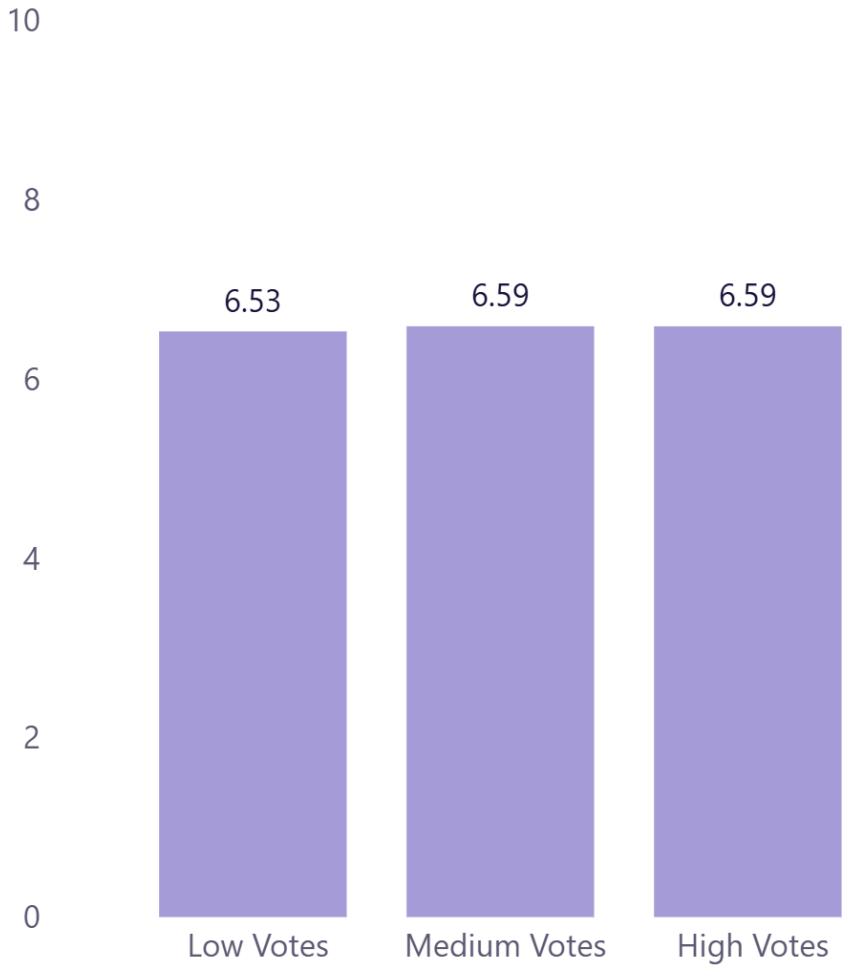
Most of the catalogue is barely seen.

Vote levels: low under 25,000; medium 25,000-250,000; high 250,000+.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 5

Popularity does not predict quality: every vote level averages about 6.5

Average rating by vote level



The 10 most-voted films and their ratings

Film	Year	Votes	Rating
Title 82	1991	1,967,408	7.50
Title 1355	1994	1,942,473	7.20
Title 1391	1985	1,937,539	6.10
Title 1018	1990	1,898,637	4.60
Title 130	2020	1,861,051	5.70
Title 1289	2003	1,797,015	6.40
Title 1433	2020	1,782,337	5.80
Title 1826	2001	1,757,196	7.00
Title 2303	1983	1,719,325	7.00
Title 2232	1985	1,711,247	7.10

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 6

Genre barely moves ratings: all 20 genres average between 6.4 and 6.8

Average rating by genre



6.76

Biography, the best-rated genre

6.42

Sci-Fi, the lowest-rated genre

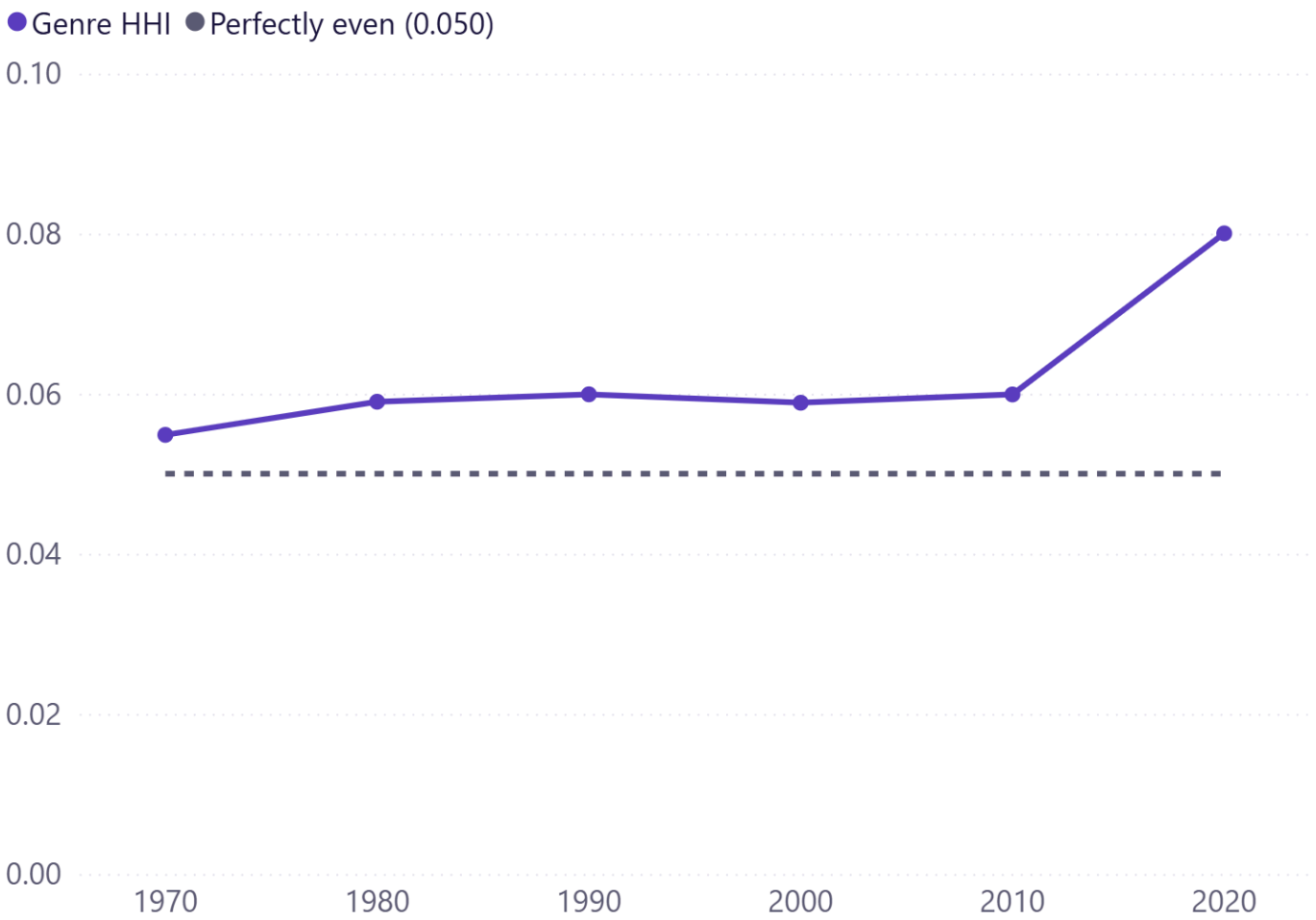
A 0.35-point spread.

Picking a genre tells you little about how well a film will be rated.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · a film can belong to more than one genre · 7

Votes are spread almost evenly across genres in every decade

Genre concentration index (HHI) by decade



0.052

concentration across all films (0.050 = even)

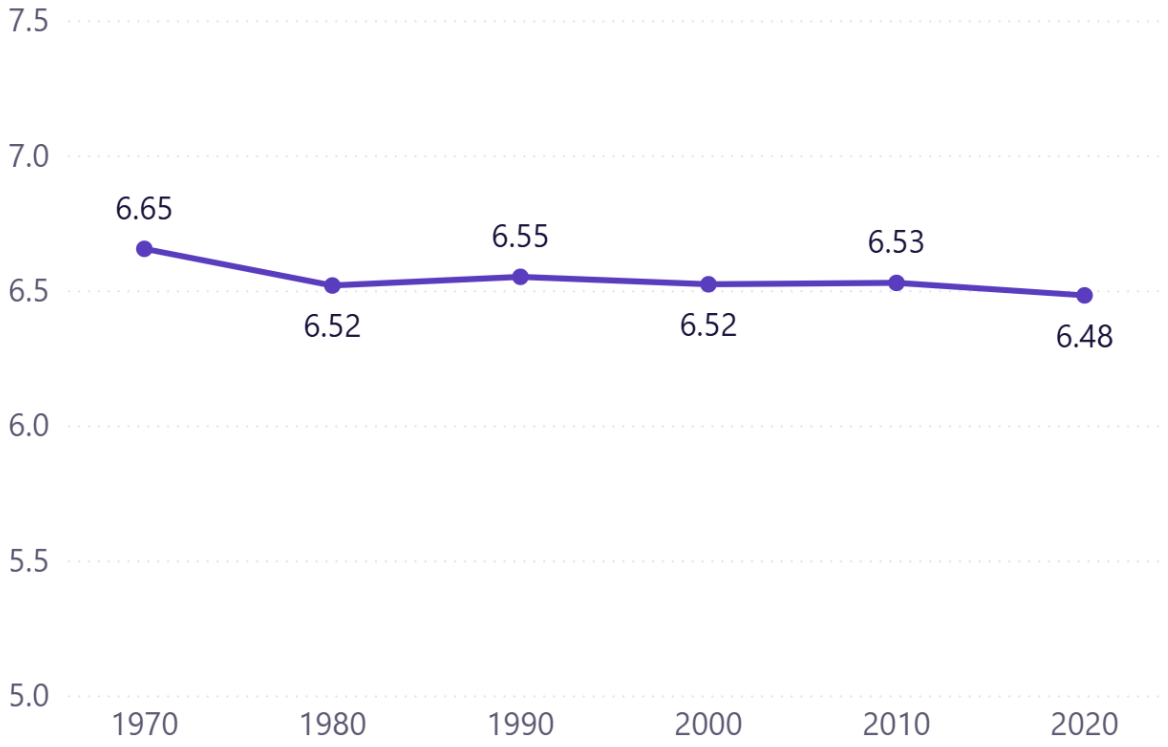
The old report said concentration was rising.

Its index squared shares that added up to about 200%, because films have two genres. Corrected, every decade sits near even; the 2020s bump comes from having only 172 films.

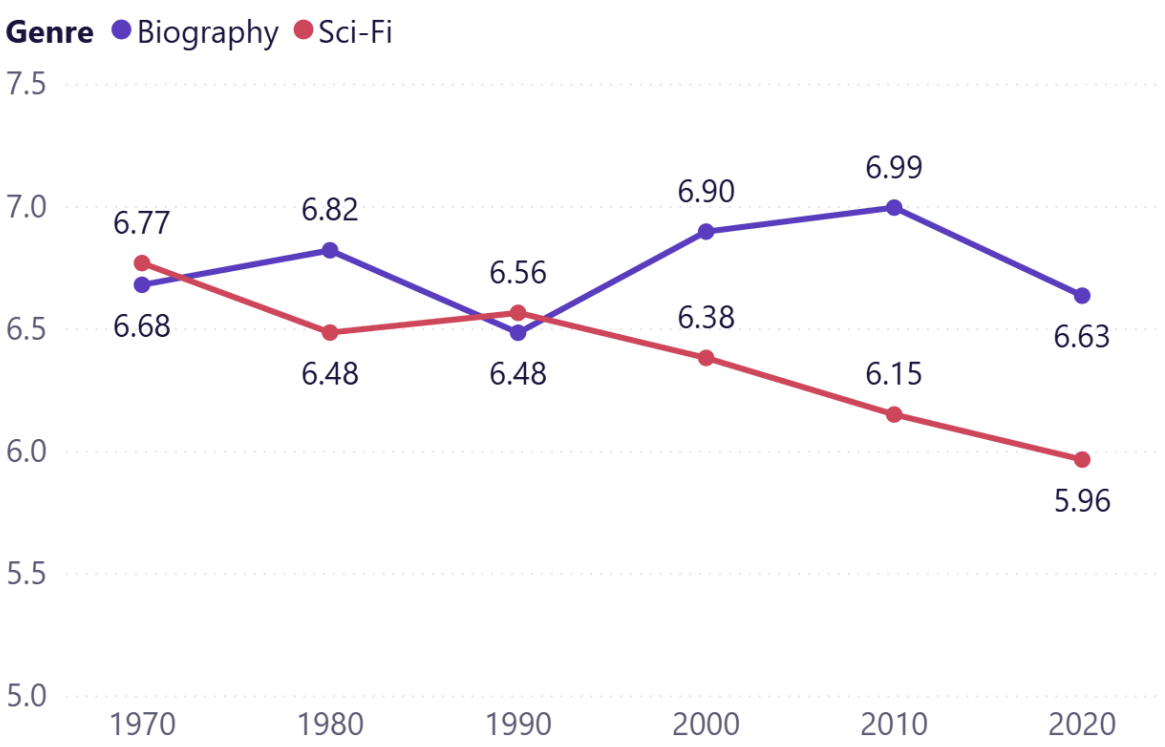
Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 8

Ratings have held at about 6.5 since the 1970s; Sci-Fi is the exception

Average rating by decade



Biography vs Sci-Fi by decade

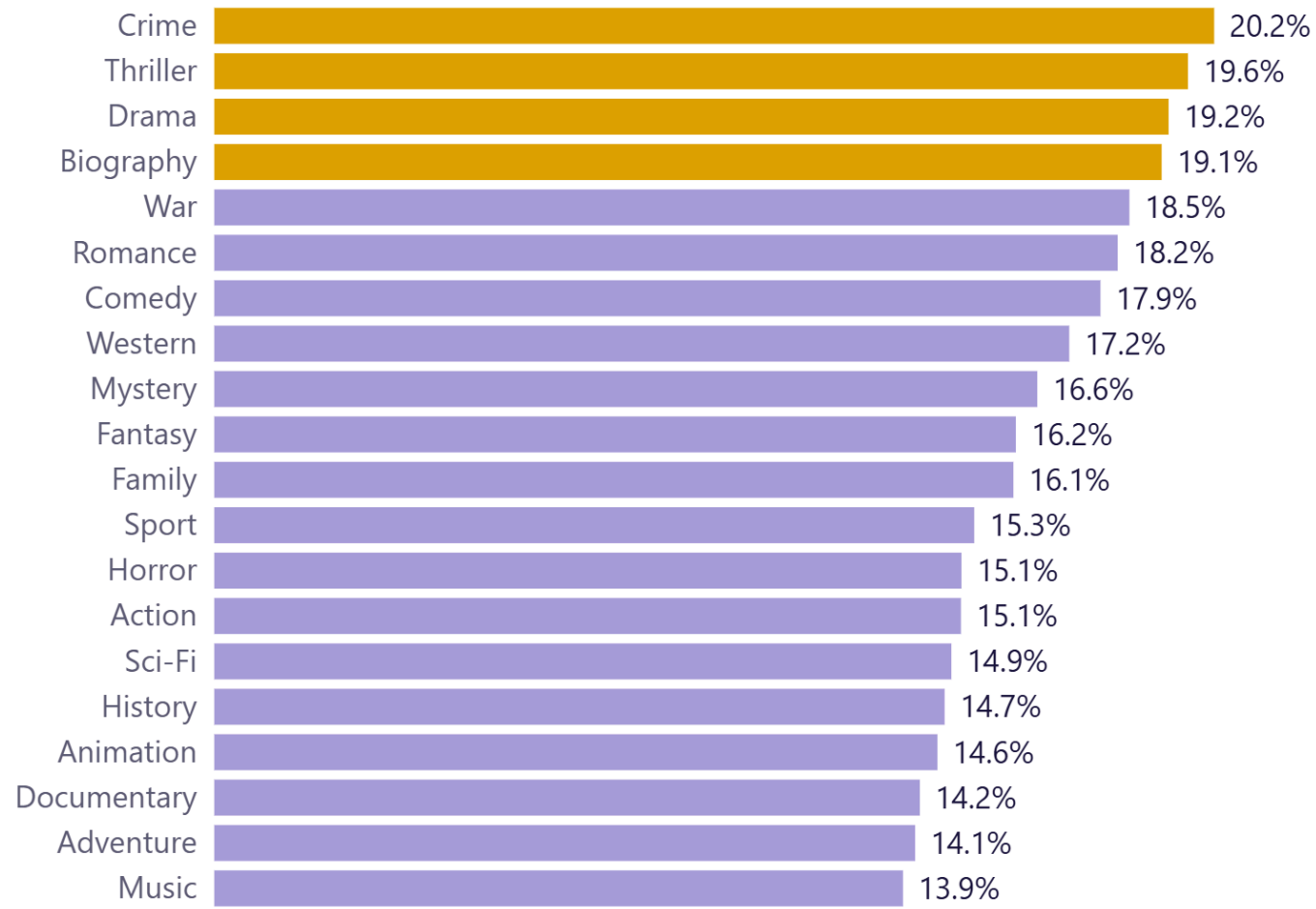


Sci-Fi lost 0.8 points from the 1970s to the 2020s; each genre has only about 40 films per decade, so treat genre trends with care.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · 2,500 films, 1970-2023 · 9

415 hidden gems: films rated 7.5+ that few people have voted for

Share of films that are hidden gems, by genre



415
hidden gems

16.6%
of films are hidden gems

8.17
average rating of the gems

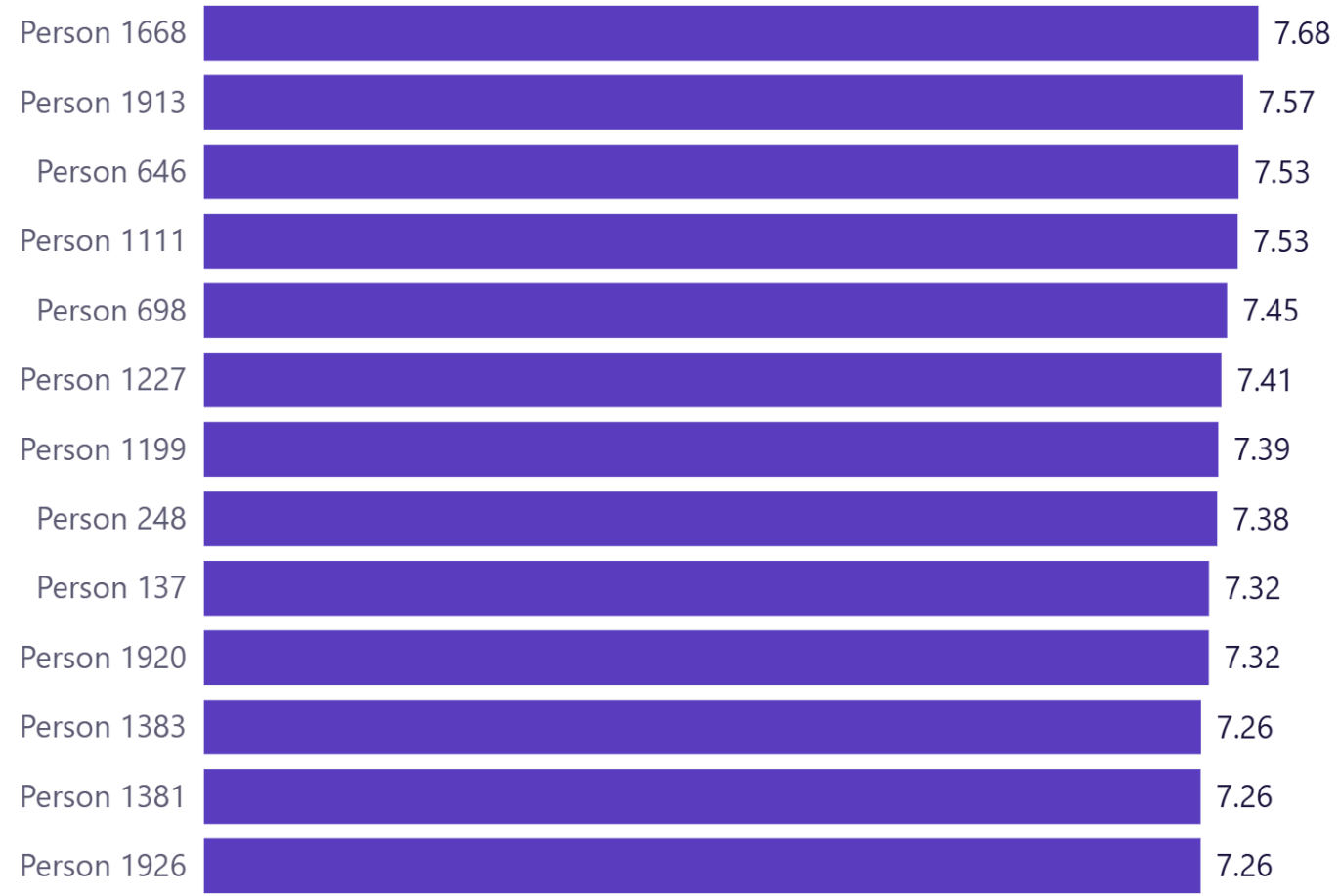
1.4%
of all votes go to the gems

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · hidden gem = rated 7.5+ with 1,000-25,000 votes · 10

Dashboards

Directors matter more than genre: their averages range from 5.1 to 7.7

Top 12 directors by average rating (5+ films)



284
directors with 5+ films

41
of them average 7 or more

2.6 points against 0.35.
Director track records spread ratings seven times more than genre does. Names are anonymised in this data.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · directors with 5 or more films · 11

Three actions: license the gems, buy by director, stop paying for popularity

1

License the hidden gems

415 films rated 7.5+ draw only 1.4% of votes, so they should be cheap. Start with Crime, Thriller, Drama and Biography, where one film in five is a gem.

Target: add 100 gems this year

2

Buy by director

Director records spread ratings by 2.6 points; genre by 0.35. Use the 41 directors averaging 7+ as the shortlist.

Target: most new licences from 7+ directors

3

Do not pay for popularity

The most-voted films are no better rated than the rest. Price on rating and fit, not vote counts.

Target: no premium for votes alone

415
hidden gems to license

41
directors averaging 7+

1.4%
of votes the gems get today

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · targets are planning goals, not forecasts · 12

Assumptions and data issues behind these numbers

Corrections to the original report

- Genre HHI squared shares that added up to about 200%; it now uses shares that add to 100%, and "rising concentration" disappears.
- The "Under 60" runtime group was 48 films with no runtime; it is now "Unknown".
- Hidden gem counts showed two decimals; now whole numbers.

Data limits

- Titles and people are anonymised (Title 3, Person 484).
- Runtimes take only a few values (90 to 180 minutes): a teaching sample.
- The 2020s are partial (2020-2023); 51 films are flagged adult and kept.
- The source workbook is missing, so the data cannot be refreshed.

Films, rating and gems by runtime

Runtime	Films	Rating	Gems
90-119	1,502	6.54	250
120-149	683	6.54	109
150+	267	6.61	43
Unknown	48	6.69	13

What still holds.

The patterns (vote concentration, the weak link between votes and rating, the director spread) are measured the same way for every film, so they are safe to act on within this catalogue.

Source: Streaming Catalogue model (Project_09_Streaming_Catalogue.xlsx) · all films · 13

CATALOGUE · 2,500 FILMS · 1970-2023 · 167M VOTES

Attention is concentrated

Decade: All | Genre: All | Runtime: All

2,500 films in the selection

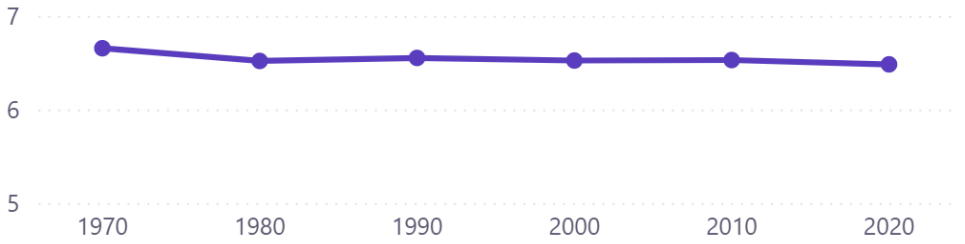
167.4M audience votes

8,720 median votes

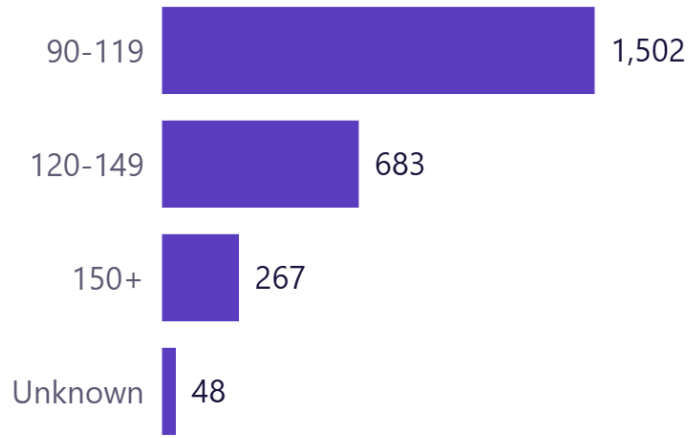
6.55 average rating

596 films rated 7.5+

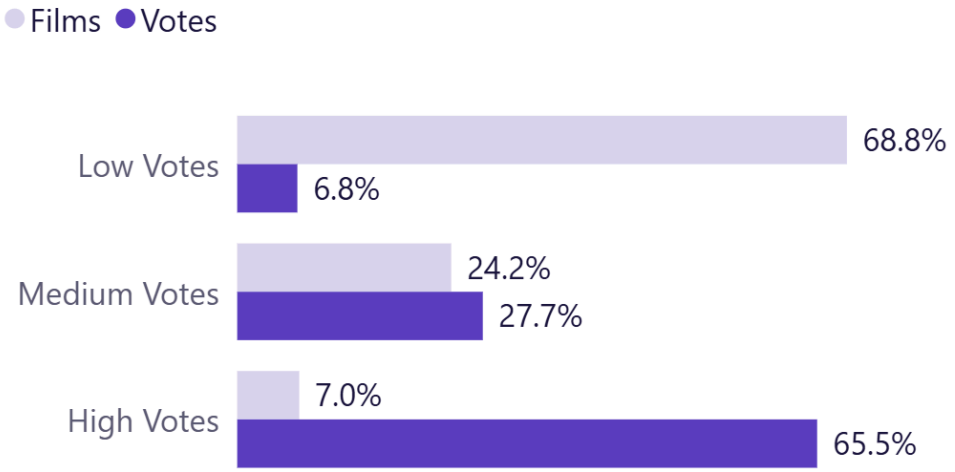
Average rating by decade



Films by runtime



Share of films vs share of votes



WHAT THIS SHOWS

7% of films hold 65% of votes.

Ratings sit near 6.5 at every vote level and in every decade.

6 in 10 films run 90-119 minutes.

Taiwo Ajayi
Report author



GENRES · 2,500 FILMS · 1970-2023 · 167M VOTES

Genre is a weak signal

Decade: All | Genre: All | Runtime: All

Mystery
genre with the most votes

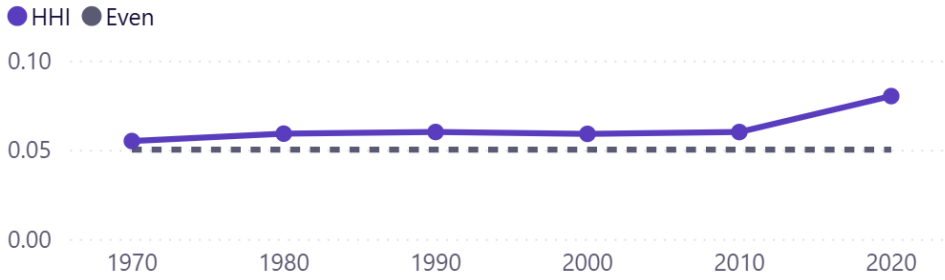
167.4M
audience votes

0.052
genre concentration

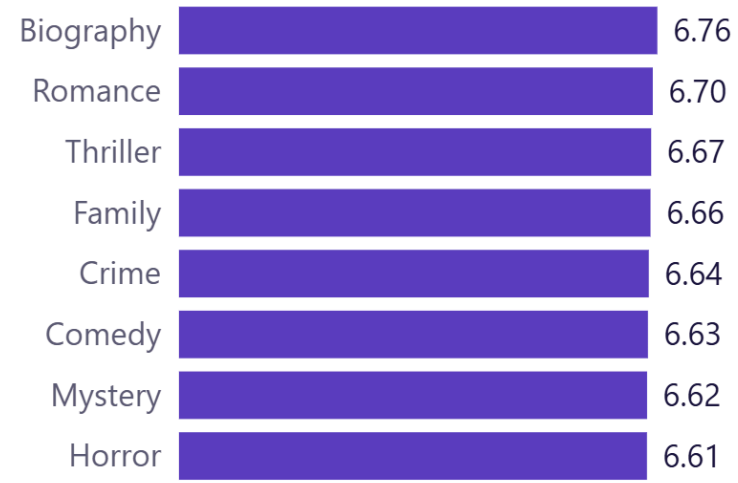
6.55
average rating

16.6%
of films are gems

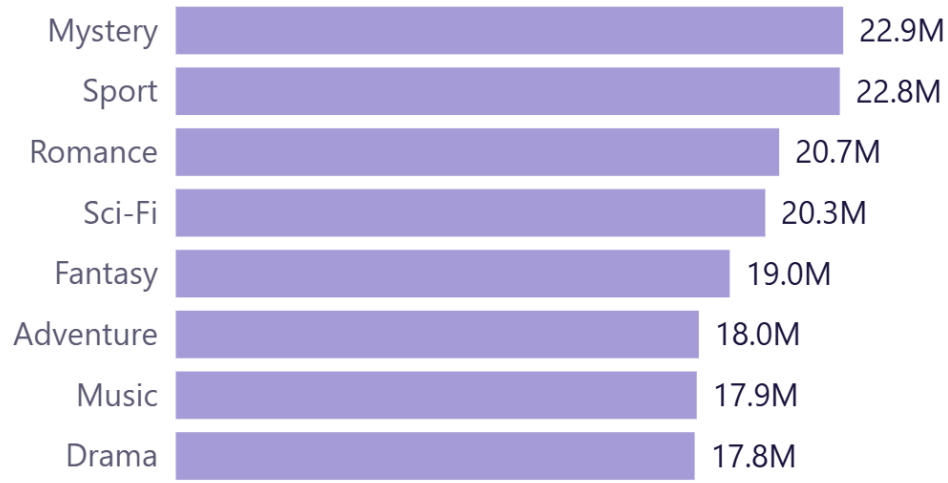
Genre concentration by decade



Top 8 genres by rating



Top 8 genres by votes



WHAT THIS SHOWS

All genres average 6.4-6.8.

Votes are spread almost evenly across genres.

Sci-Fi fell from 6.8 in the 1970s to 6.0 in the 2020s.

Story | Catalogue | **Genres** | Gems & talent

Taiwo Ajayi
Report author



GEMS & TALENT · 2,500 FILMS · 1970-2023 · 167M VOTES

Where the value is

Decade: All | Genre: All | Runtime: All

415
hidden gems

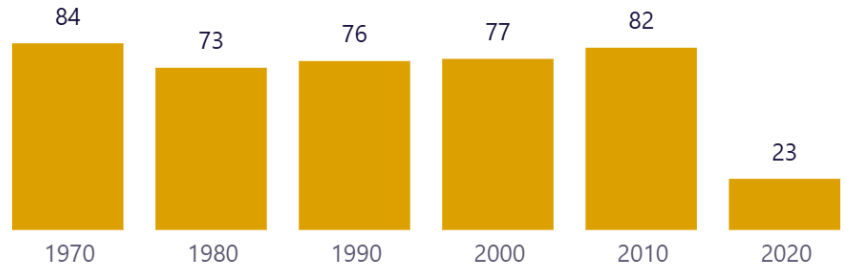
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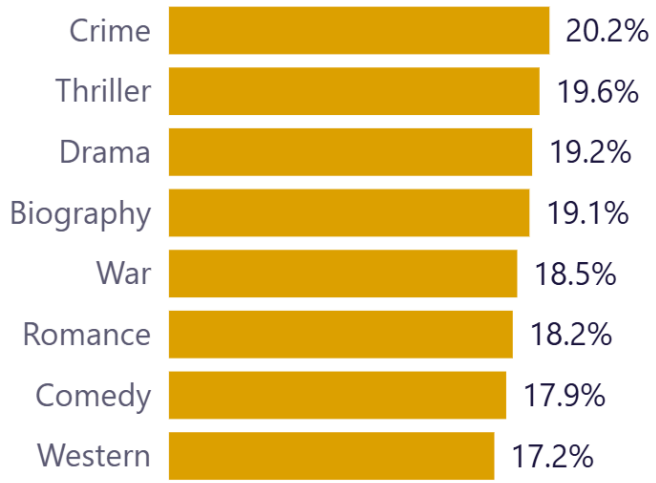
1.4%
of votes go to gems

41
average 7 or more

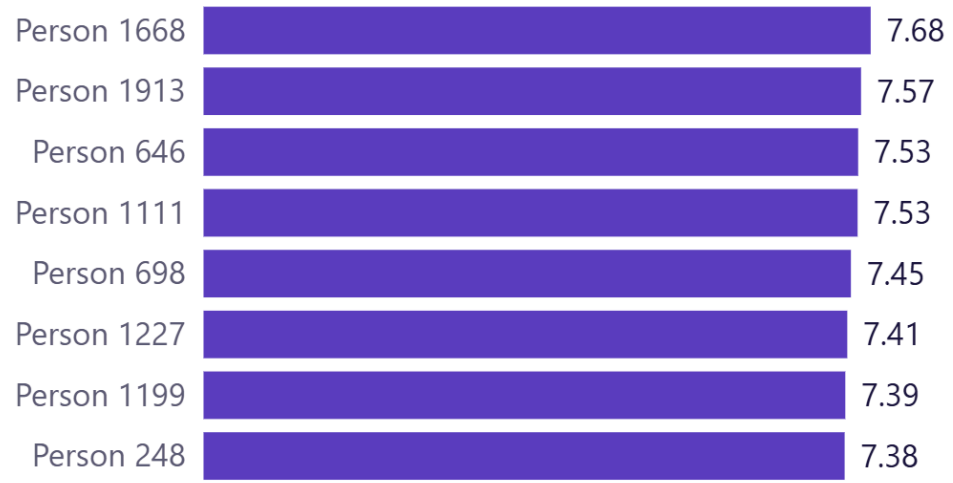
Hidden gems by decade



Top 8 genres by gem rate



Top 8 directors, 5+ films (right-click for profile)



WHAT THIS SHOWS

415 gems average 8.17 but get 1.4% of votes.

Crime and Thriller have the most gems for their size.

41 directors average 7 or more.

Taiwo Ajayi
Report author



Director profile: films, ratings and gems for the selected director

Back

2500
films directed

6.55
average rating

415
hidden gems

167,366K
audience votes

Films, best rated first

Film	Year	Rating	Votes
Title 1500	2017	9.50	5,556
Title 2418	1975	9.50	22,536
Title 2497	2001	9.50	7,904
Title 492	1975	9.50	9,209
Title 726	2018	9.50	13,324
Title 768	2018	9.50	5,563
Title 468	2003	9.40	9,770
Title 1861	2019	9.30	27,380
Title 1940	2022	9.20	39,057
Title 524	1987	9.20	5,273
Title 678	2015	9.20	5,521
Title 1412	2005	9.10	8,590
Title 2173	2002	9.10	29,264
Title 331	2013	9.10	5,138

Films by genre

